nachāq in Balkh. Accordingly, they summoned all their brothers, sons of Sulṭān Ḥusayn Mīrzā, and cruised out of Herī to finish the determined purpose.

When they reached Chihil-dukhtarān, other sons of Sulṭān Husayn had begun to join in. Abū'l-muḥsin joined them from Marv and Ibn-i-ḥusayn followed, coming up from Tūn. Qāīn Kūpuk was then in Mashhad. Many words were sent to him, and he approached but gave back nothing but senseless opinions. Babur has talked of a sense of jealousy between Muẓaffar Mīrzā and Qāīn Kūpuk, given that former was made a joint ruler. He said, 'How should I go to his presence?' directly hinting of jealousy being because of his absence.

And when all other brothers of Qāīn had come together to resolute against the enemy Shaybāni Khān, Qāīn Kūpuk did not reflect any emotion whatsoever with regards to the clan of Timur. Everyone saw this as an act of cowardice.

The *Baburnama* has a description of the situation:[*]

> One word! In this world acts such as his outlive the man; if a man have any share of intelligence, why try to be ill-spoken of after death? if he be ambitious, why not try so to act that, he gone, men will praise him? In the honorable mention of their names, wise men find a second life!

The envoys of Mīrzās along with Muhammad Barandūq Barlās came to Babur too. Babur was all set for this adventure as he indeed had travelled around 600 miles only for it. Babur began to ride with Muhammad Barandūq Beg for Murgh-āb[17] where all Mīrzās had assembled.

Babur Sees the Mīrzās

On 26 October of AD 1506, Babur met the Mīrzās, the people from his clan. One of them, Abū'l-muḥsin Mīrzā came riding around a mile to welcome Babur. Both dismounted and approached each other with a smile. Sharing a courtesy greeting with a hug, both mounted back beginning to ride towards the camp. As they reached closer to the camp, Muẓaffar Mīrzā and Ibn-i-Husayn Mīrzā came to meet them. Since both were younger than Abū'l-muḥsin, Babur expected them to have come further than him for welcome, but they could not think much about the influence of the alcohol. Babur offered his courtesy greetings without dismounting from the horse.

They rode together and greetings and a sense of welcome were continually showered by the crowd till they dismounted at the Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā's Gate. The crowd's emotions surged while welcoming Babur. A few jumped off